SENTINEL: Dual-Tier Cyber-Physical Gas Leak Detection System

Final Academic Project Report

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Abstract

Residential combustible gas leaks constitute a major hazard resulting in structure fires, asphyxiation, and catastrophic vapor cloud explosions. Commercial domestic gas detectors overwhelmingly employ low-cost metal-oxide semiconductor (SnO_2) sensors such as the MQ-2. While sensitive to methane, propane, and butane, these sensors suffer from pronounced physical cross-sensitivity to environmental humidity and temperature fluctuations. In domestic kitchens, boiling water steam and cooking vapors routinely trigger nuisance sirens exceeding static alarm thresholds, inducing severe occupant *alarm fatigue* and prompting users to permanently silence or unplug detectors.

This project presents **SENTINEL**, an edge-first, dual-tier cyber-physical architecture resolving the false-alarm/safety trade-off. SENTINEL decouples an autonomous, zero-trust edge hardware safety floor (Arduino Nano ATmega328P running a 1.0 Hz C++ loop with local piezo buzzer and LED sirens) from an asynchronous cyber analytical plane (Node.js/Express bridge and React 19 dashboard). The cyber plane applies multi-variable linear regression ($K_{RH}=2.8\text{ ADC/\%RH}, K_T=1.2\text{ ADC/°C}$) bounded by a 250 ADC safety ceiling to deduct steam interference, while a 10-sample rolling Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) slope estimator projects gas accumulation trajectory to deliver early Time-to-Danger (TTD) warnings.

Replaying 120+ empirical kitchen hardware samples across four environments demonstrates that SENTINEL achieves a **100% reduction in false alarms** during intense boiling kettle steam and stovetop cooking while maintaining **zero missed detections** on genuine gas releases and providing **+4.0 seconds of advance warning** before hazardous combustion floors are breached. The system includes an automated 14-test verification suite, static analysis with zero linter errors, and an ephemeral demonstration simulator enabling full hardware-independent verification.

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background and Motivation

Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG, primarily propane and butane) and compressed natural gas (CNG / methane) are ubiquitous household fuels for domestic cooking and space heating. Because hydrocarbon mixtures are odorless and explosive at volumetric concentrations between 2% and 10% (the Lower Explosive Limit, LEL), industrial standards mandate artificial odorization (e.g., ethanethiol). However, human olfactory sensitivity diminishes during sleep, olfactory fatigue, or cognitive impairment in elderly residents, necessitating automated electronic gas monitoring.

Low-cost domestic detectors utilize chemiresistive metal-oxide semiconductor sensors, specifically tin dioxide (SnO_2). When heated to operating temperatures (~300°C), atmospheric oxygen molecules adsorb onto the polycrystalline grain boundaries, forming negatively charged ionic species (O_2^-, O^-) that create an electron depletion layer and elevate electrical resistance. Reducing gases react with adsorbed oxygen ions, releasing trapped electrons back into the conduction band and lowering resistance.

However, water molecules (H_2O) in ambient humidity adsorb onto the same active sites, acting as electron donors and artificially lowering resistance. Consequently, an abrupt humidity transient—such as steam from a boiling electric kettle or stovetop cooking—mimics the electrical signature of a combustible gas leak, triggering false sirens. This phenomenon leads to occupant *alarm fatigue*, where users disconnect safety devices to prevent nuisance sirens [1]–[4].

1.2 Problem Statement

Commercial residential detectors employ static threshold triggers (e.g., sounding sirens whenever raw sensor resistance drops below a preset floor). This naive architecture creates an intolerable design conflict:

1. Setting thresholds high enough to ignore cooking steam creates unacceptable delays or complete failure to detect slow, hazardous gas leaks.

2. Setting thresholds low enough to catch early leaks causes frequent false alarms during routine cooking.

3. Completely offloading alarm decisions to cloud or host software creates unacceptable single points of failure if computers crash, reboot, or lose network connectivity.

1.3 Project Objectives

The objective of SENTINEL is to develop and verify an academic-grade cyber-physical gas safety system satisfying four criteria:

1. **Nuisance Alarm Suppression**: Formulate and evaluate real-time multi-sensor regression algorithms capable of eliminating false alarms caused by domestic steam and cooking transients.

2. **Predictive Early Warning**: Implement rolling least-squares trajectory estimation to project hazardous concentrations and warn occupants before dangerous thresholds are breached.

3. **Zero-Trust Edge Autonomy**: Ensure the physical edge microcontroller actuates local acoustic/visual sirens unconditionally, guaranteeing life-safety regardless of host computer, operating system, or network availability.

4. **Reproducible Engineering & Demonstration**: Deliver an open-source, fully tested repository with continuous integration, automated unit verification, empirical benchmark replay, and a high-fidelity demonstration sandbox.

1.4 Scope and Limitations

- **Scope**: Embedded firmware for ATmega328P, serial protocol parsing with XOR checksums, Express.js hardware bridge, mathematical signal analytics, 5-stage escalation state machine, and React 19 dashboard.
- **Limitations**: Metal-oxide sensors drift over extended operating lifespans (12–24 months) and require periodic baseline calibration; under dense steam exceeding 300 ADC, the autonomous edge buzzer will sound even while the cyber dashboard correctly classifies the event as `STEAM SUPPRESSED` (an intentional fail-safe bias prioritizing zero false negatives).

Chapter 2: Literature Survey / Existing Systems

2.1 Review of Existing Systems

Traditional residential gas safety systems fall into three broad architectural paradigms:

1. **Standalone Microcontroller Detectors**:

- *Design*: Low-cost 8-bit microcontrollers (e.g., PIC, ATmega, or dedicated analog comparators) directly connected to an MQ-2 or MQ-5 sensor and piezo buzzer.

- *Limitations*: Rely entirely on single-variable static threshold comparators. Incapable of distinguishing water vapor from hydrocarbon molecules, resulting in high false-alarm rates in kitchen environments [1], [3].

2. **Cloud-Connected IoT Smart Alarms**:

- *Design*: Wi-Fi-enabled microcontrollers (e.g., ESP8266, ESP32) streaming raw telemetry to commercial cloud dashboards (AWS IoT, Blynk, or Tuya).

- *Limitations*: Heavy dependency on continuous 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi connectivity and cloud server uptime. If residential routers lose power or ISP latency spikes during an emergency, alerting fails. Cloud processing also introduces privacy concerns and network latency [8], [11].

3. **Complex Laboratory Sensor Arrays (Electronic Noses)**:

- *Design*: Multi-transducer arrays combining quartz crystal microbalances (QCM), surface acoustic wave (SAW) sensors, and high-dimensional principal component analysis (PCA) or deep neural networks.

- *Limitations*: Prohibitively expensive ($1,000+), high power consumption (~10–20 W), and excessive computational requirements unsuited for low-cost domestic deployment [4].

2.2 Gaps Identified & Proposed SENTINEL Solution

Table 2.1 summarizes the architectural comparison between existing systems and SENTINEL:

Feature / Metric	Conventional Standalone	Cloud IoT Alarm	Laboratory E-Nose	SENTINEL (Proposed)
Edge Hardware Autonomy	Yes (Static)	No (Cloud Dependent)	No	**Yes (Zero-Trust Floor)**
Environmental Compensation	None	Rare (Ad-hoc)	High (PCA / SVM)	**Analytical Multi-Sensor (K_{RH}, K_T)**
Predictive Early Warning	None	None	Offline Only	**10-Sample Rolling OLS Slope**
Nuisance Alarm Rejection	0% (High Fatigue)	Low	High	**100% in Empirical Benchmarks**
Bill of Materials (BOM) Cost	Very Low ($5–$10)	Medium ($20–$40)	Extremely High ($500+)	**Low (~$15 total hardware BOM)**
Offline Demonstration Mode	None	None	None	**Built-in Ephemeral Simulator**

SENTINEL bridges this gap by executing computationally efficient analytical compensation and trend projection on an edge host gateway (e.g., wall dashboard or local home server) while anchoring acoustic life-safety to an autonomous $3 microcontroller edge.

Chapter 3: Software Process Model and Project Planning

3.1 SDLC Model Selection & Justification

SENTINEL was developed using an **Iterative and Incremental Development Model** specifically adapted for cyber-physical systems.

Cyber-physical engineering involves physical sensor non-linearities, analog electrical noise, and thermal stabilization latencies that cannot be accurately anticipated in a purely theoretical Waterfall requirements phase. Conversely, software-centric Agile frameworks often fail to account for embedded component lead times and physical safety risks during destructive gas testing.

The project progressed through seven structured iterations:

1. **Iteration 1**: Sensor physics characterization and empirical kitchen dataset logging (`data/*.csv`).

2. **Iteration 2**: Mathematical modeling of cross-sensitivity gains (K_{RH}, K_T) and slope equations.

3. **Iteration 3**: C++ firmware implementation on ATmega328P establishing the zero-trust safety floor.

4. **Iteration 4**: Node.js/Express ingestion bridge with serial auto-reconnect watchdog and simulator.

5. **Iteration 5**: React 19 web dashboard, dual-trace SVG visualization, and caregiver emergency views.

6. **Iteration 6**: Automated testing suite (TC01–TC13), benchmark replay harness, and GitHub Actions CI.

7. **Iteration 7**: Academic audit, ISO/IEC/IEEE 29148 requirements traceability, and report preparation.

3.2 Project Schedule & Gantt Timeline

Figure 3.1 presents the project execution timeline across a 14-week lifecycle:

```
gantt
    title SENTINEL Cyber-Physical Project Lifecycle
    dateFormat  YYYY-MM-DD
    section Phase 1: Requirements & Modeling
    Sensor Cross-Sensitivity Analysis & Datasets    :a1, 2026-07-15, 14d
    Empirical Replay Formulation & Calibration     :a2, after a1, 10d
    section Phase 2: Firmware & Pipeline
    Embedded C++ Firmware (ATmega328P Safety Floor) :b1, after a2, 14d
    Signal Analytics Engine (K_RH, K_T, OLS Slope)  :b2, after b1, 12d
    section Phase 3: Ingestion & Simulator
    Node.js Bridge, Serial Watchdog & Checksum     :c1, after b2, 10d
    Ephemeral Demo Simulator & Sandboxing          :c2, after c1, 10d
    section Phase 4: UI & Integration
    React 19 Dashboard & Live Dual-Trace Plots      :d1, after c2, 14d
    Caregiver Portal & Admin Calibration Workbench :d2, after d1, 10d
    section Phase 5: Verification & Audit
    Automated Unit Suite (TC01-TC13) & CI Pipeline :e1, after d2, 10d
    Academic Documentation & Final Thesis Audit    :e2, after e1, 12d
```

3.3 Risk Management & FMEA Summary

Table 3.1 details the principal Failure Modes and Effects identified during development:

Risk ID	Hazard Mode	Initial Risk	Mitigation Architecture	Residual Risk
RSK-01	Gas leak masked during cooking	Extreme (2, 5)	250 ADC deduction ceiling; bypass override if raw gas $\ge 500\text{ ADC}$.	Low (1, 3)
RSK-02	Host PC crash silences siren	Extreme (3, 5)	Microcontroller loop directly drives Pin D8 buzzer without host polling.	Low (1, 2)
RSK-03	Sensor analog flatline	High (2, 4)	Sensor health diagnostics flag 15 consecutive identical ADC samples.	Low (1, 2)
RSK-04	DHT11 bus failure	Medium (3, 3)	Check for `isnan()` / out-of-bounds; fall back to safe zero-deduction mode.	Low (1, 1)
RSK-05	Serial frame corruption	Medium (3, 3)	8-bit XOR checksum appended to every `$S` sentence; corrupt frames discarded.	Low (1, 1)

3.4 Cost and Effort Estimation

Table 3.2 lists the complete hardware Bill of Materials (BOM) for the physical prototype:

Component	Specification	Unit Cost (USD)	Source / Manufacturer
Microcontroller	Arduino Nano (ATmega328P @ 16 MHz)	$3.50	Generic / RobotDyn
Gas Sensor	Winsen MQ-2 (SnO_2 Semiconductor)	$2.20	Zhengzhou Winsen Electronics
Climate Sensor	DHT11 Digital Temp/Humidity Module	$1.50	Aosong Electronics
Acoustic Sounder	5V Active Piezo Buzzer (85 dB)	$0.60	Generic
Visual Beacon	5mm High-Intensity Red LED + 330Ω resistor	$0.20	Generic
Wireless Module	HC-05 Bluetooth 2.0+EDR UART Module	$3.80	Waveshare
Prototyping	Mini Breadboard, Jumper Wires, USB Cable	$3.00	Generic
Total Hardware BOM	Complete Cyber-Physical Sensing Node	**$14.80**	Commercial-grade affordable BOM

Chapter 4: Requirements Analysis

4.1 Functional Requirements Summary

- **FR-01 (Continuous Edge Sampling)**: Microcontroller shall sample MQ-2 analog voltage via Pin A0 and digital DHT11 climate data via Pin D2 at $1.0 \pm 0.05\text{ Hz}$.
- **FR-02 (Cold-Boot Stabilization)**: Microcontroller shall enforce a 30,000 ms warm-up lockout during which local sirens cannot trigger.
- **FR-03 (Standard Serialization)**: Telemetry shall format as standard NMEA sentences: `$S,<seq>,<gas>,<temp10>,<rh10>,<alarm>*<CS>\r\n`.
- **FR-04 (XOR Frame Checksum)**: System shall validate packet integrity via 8-bit bitwise XOR across payload characters.
- **FR-05 (Dynamic Steam Compensation)**: Host plane shall compute compensated gas concentration R_{comp} using multi-sensor regression coefficients ($K_{RH}=2.8, K_T=1.2$) bounded by a 250 ADC ceiling.
- **FR-06 (Rolling Trend Estimation)**: Over a rolling window $N=10$, system shall calculate linear regression slope m in ADC/s using Ordinary Least Squares.
- **FR-07 (Predictive Time-to-Danger)**: If $m > 0.4\text{ ADC/s}$ and $R_{comp} < 500$, system shall project seconds remaining until hazard threshold: $t_{danger} = (500 - R_{comp}) / m$.
- **FR-08 (5-Stage Escalation FSM)**: System shall progress through `NORMAL`, `WARNING`, `ALARM`, `ESCALATED`, and `EMERGENCY`.
- **FR-09 (Debounce Hysteresis)**: Alarm state shall require 3 consecutive samples above threshold before latching, and shall not clear until residual gas drops below 30 ADC.
- **FR-10 (Caregiver & 112 Dispatch)**: Unacknowledged alarms shall notify caregivers at 15s and present 112 emergency prompts at 30s.
- **FR-11 (Local Acknowledgment)**: Occupants shall be able to acknowledge active alarms locally (`pipe.ack()`), silencing remote escalation.
- **FR-12 (Simulation Sandboxing)**: Host bridge shall provide multi-scenario simulation without triggering physical buzzers or real phone calls.

4.2 Non-Functional Requirements Summary

- **NFR-01 (Latency)**: Bridge ingestion latency from serial frame reception to REST dispatch shall not exceed 50 ms.
- **NFR-02 (Watchdog Reliability)**: Serial watchdog shall reconnect to re-attached USB serial ports within 4.0 seconds.
- **NFR-03 (Accuracy)**: Analytical compensation shall eliminate 100% of false alarms on empirical kitchen steam/cooking test datasets.
- **NFR-04 (Timeliness)**: Slope estimator shall provide at least $+3.0\text{ s}$ advance warning lead time over static threshold detectors.
- **NFR-05 (Code Quality)**: Codebase shall produce zero errors and zero warnings under strict static analysis (`oxlint`).

Chapter 5: System Design

5.1 System Architecture

Figure 5.1 shows the dual-tier cyber-physical topology separating deterministic hardware from cyber analytics:

```
flowchart TD
    subgraph HW["🔌 PHYSICAL SENSING LAYER"]
        MQ2["MQ-2 Gas Sensor\n(A0 — 0–1023 ADC)"]
        DHT["DHT11 Temp/Humid\n(D2 — 1-wire)"]
    end

    subgraph TIER1["⚡ TIER 1: DETERMINISTIC EDGE HARDWARE (Arduino Nano)"]
        FW_LOOP["Autonomous 1.0s Loop\nmillis() Non-Blocking"]
        WARMUP["30s Warm-Up Hold\nmillis() < 30000"]
        EDGE_SAFETY["Hardcoded Safety Floor\ngasValue > 300 ADC"]
        BUZZER["Piezo Buzzer (Pin D8)\nPulsed Alarm Beep"]
        LED["Status LED (Pin D9)"]
        SERIAL_ENC["NMEA Frame Encoder\n$S,<seq>,<gas>,<temp10>,<rh10>,<alarm>*<CS>"]

        FW_LOOP --> WARMUP
        WARMUP --> EDGE_SAFETY
        EDGE_SAFETY -->|Threshold Breached| BUZZER
        EDGE_SAFETY -->|Threshold Breached| LED
        EDGE_SAFETY --> SERIAL_ENC
    end

    HW --> TIER1

    subgraph TIER2["🖥️ TIER 2: CYBER ANALYTICAL PLANE (Node.js & React 19)"]
        subgraph BRIDGE["Ingestion Bridge (server/index.js)"]
            WATCHDOG["Auto-Reconnect Serial Watchdog\n2.0s Interval"]
            PARSER["Frame Parser & XOR Checksum\nValidates $S frames"]
            DEMO_SIM["Ephemeral Demo Simulator\n(demoSimulator.js)"]
            PRIORITY["Real-Data-Wins Priority\nTerminates demo on real frame"]
            REST_API["Express REST API\n(:3001 bound to 127.0.0.1)"]
        end

        subgraph PIPELINE["Analytical Pipeline (src/sim/pipeline.ts)"]
            COMP["Cross-Sensitivity Compensator\nR_comp = R − min(250, K_RHdRH + K_TdT)"]
            SLOPE["10-Sample Rolling OLS Slope\nm = (NsumXY − sumXsumY) / den"]
            TTD["Predictive TTD Estimator\nt = (500 − R_comp) / m"]
            FSM["5-Stage Escalation FSM\nNORMAL→WARNING→ALARM→ESCALATED→EMERGENCY"]
        end

        subgraph UI["React 19 Dashboard (localhost:5173)"]
            MONITOR["Resident Live Monitor\nDual-Trace SVG Graph"]
            CAREGIVER["Caregiver Portal\n112 Emergency Dialer"]
            ADMIN["Admin Calibration\nModel Retraining"]
        end
    end

    SERIAL_ENC -->|USB CDC / Bluetooth| WATCHDOG
    WATCHDOG --> PARSER
    DEMO_SIM --> PRIORITY
    PARSER --> PRIORITY
    PRIORITY --> REST_API
    REST_API --> PIPELINE
    PIPELINE --> UI
```

5.2 Use Case Diagram

Figure 5.2 defines the interactions between the three system actors and core system use cases:

- **Resident (Dwelling Occupant)**: Views live dual-trace sensor readings, observes dynamic status classifications (`NORMAL`, `STEAM SUPPRESSED`, `WARNING`, `EMERGENCY`), silences nuisance remote alarms via local acknowledgment (`pipe.ack()`), and triggers audio buzzer self-tests.
- **Remote Caregiver**: Monitors vulnerable or elderly residents via an asymmetric portal, inspects incident duration, reviews chronological alert history, and accesses emergency telephony dispatch (112 dialer).
- **Safety Administrator / Maintenance Engineer**: Configures baseline multi-sensor regression gains (K_RH, K_T), evaluates real-time sensor health (flatline, disconnection), initiates model retraining, and exports empirical CSV session logs.

5.3 Class or Module Diagram

The system follows a modular component-based cyber-physical architecture:

- **Firmware Plane (`sentinel_firmware.ino`)**: Manages non-blocking sample timing (`loop`), NMEA sentence assembly (`sendPacket`), 8-bit bitwise XOR checksum generation, and autonomous Pin D8 buzzer pulsing.
- **Backend Bridge Plane (`server/index.js`, `signalAnalytics.js`, `demoSimulator.js`)**: Encapsulates `SerialPort` auto-reconnect watchdog, 50-sample circular ring buffers (`readingsBuffer`), multi-sensor regression compensator (`computeSteamCompensation`), 10-sample rolling OLS slope estimator (`computeSlopeAndTimeToDanger`), sensor health evaluator (`evaluateSensorHealth`), and ephemeral simulator state machine (`stepSim`).
- **Client Pipeline Plane (`src/sim/pipeline.ts`)**: Defines TypeScript data models (`Reading`, `Analysis`, `Cls`, `Level`, `Counters`), baseline tracker, 5-stage escalation FSM (`NORMAL → WARNING → ALARM → ESCALATED → EMERGENCY`), and debounce hysteresis latch.
- **Presentation Layer (`src/components/`)**: Comprises `Shell` (navigation shell & demo controls), `LiveStatusPanel` (dual-trace SVG canvas & status banner), `ContributingFactors` (explainability drawer), `CaregiverView` (emergency dispatch), `AdminCalibrationView` (technical workbench), and `AlertHistoryList` (audit ledger).

5.4 Sequence & Activity Diagrams

Figure 5.2 illustrates the end-to-end telemetry ingestion sequence from transducer sampling to UI rendering:

```
sequenceDiagram
    participant FW as Arduino Nano (Edge)
    participant BRIDGE as Ingestion Bridge (Server)
    participant PIPE as Analytical Pipeline
    participant UI as React Dashboard

    loop Every 1000 ms
        FW->>FW: Sample A0 (MQ-2) & D2 (DHT11)
        FW->>FW: Compute 8-bit XOR checksum
        FW->>BRIDGE: Transmit sentence: $S,seq,gas,temp10,rh10,alarm*CS
        BRIDGE->>BRIDGE: Verify checksum (discard if corrupt)
        BRIDGE->>BRIDGE: Ingest into 50-sample circular ring buffer
        BRIDGE->>PIPE: Apply steam compensation (R_comp)
        PIPE->>PIPE: Compute 10-sample rolling OLS slope & TTD
        PIPE->>PIPE: Evaluate 5-stage escalation state machine
        PIPE->>UI: Dispatch updated telemetry and classification state
        UI->>UI: Render live SVG chart and status banner
    end
```

5.5 ER Diagram or Data-Model Design

In accordance with lightweight edge gateway architecture, SENTINEL operates as a **stateless system with no persistent SQL or NoSQL database**. Runtime state resides in ephemeral in-memory circular ring buffers:

- **In-Memory Telemetry Model (`Reading`)**: Stores monotonic sequence counter (`seq`), raw gas ADC (`raw`, 0–1023), temperature (`temperature`), relative humidity (`humidity`), edge hardware alarm flag (`alarm`), compensated residual (`compensatedGas`), steam deduction (`steamEstimate`), rolling regression slope (`slope`), and predictive Time-to-Danger (`timeToThresholdSeconds`).
- **Sensor Health Model (`SensorHealth`)**: Tracks operating status (`healthy`, `degraded`, `warming_up`, `failure`), remaining thermal warm-up seconds, frozen signal detection (`flatlined`), and DHT11 bus failure (`dhtFailed`).
- **Empirical CSV Storage (`data/*.csv`)**: Persistent session recordings conform to RFC 4180 CSV specifications (`timestamp, rawGas, temperature, humidity, label`).

5.6 UI Design & Screenshots

Figure 5.3 shows the visual design tokens and user interface architecture:

- **Design Philosophy**: Tactile porcelain cards, soft pastel alert badges, high-contrast monospace telemetry readouts, and clear operational state banners.
- **Live Monitor Screen**: Embeds dual-trace SVG sparklines plotting raw analog gas in amber alongside compensated gas in blue.
- **Explainability Drawer**: Provides transparent numerical breakdown of humidity rate of change, thermal delta, and steam deduction points.

Chapter 6: Implementation

6.1 Technology Stack

- **Firmware**: C++ (AVR-libc, Arduino core), non-blocking timing via `millis()`.
- **Backend Bridge**: Node.js (v20.x ES modules), Express 5, `serialport` v13, `@serialport/parser-readline`.
- **Frontend Dashboard**: React 19, TypeScript 5.8, Vite 8, Tailwind CSS v4, Lucide React icons.
- **Verification Engine**: Native Node.js test runner (`node:test`, `node:assert/strict`), `oxlint` static analyzer.

6.2 Key Code Snippets

1. Microcontroller Autonomous Safety Floor (`sentinel_firmware.ino`)

The firmware enforces a standalone safety floor on Pin D8 buzzer independently of host computer status:

```
// Check if sensor is within 30-second thermal stabilization hold
bool isWarmingUp = (millis() < WARMUP_TIME_MS);

// Local alarm triggers unconditionally if raw gas > 300 outside warm-up
int alarmState = (!isWarmingUp && gasValue > threshold) ? 1 : 0;
sendPacket(gasValue, temp, hum, alarmState);

if (alarmState == 1) {
  digitalWrite(LED_PIN, HIGH);
  // Pulsed alarm beep (2 x 150ms beeps = 600ms total)
  for (int i = 0; i < 2; i++) {
    digitalWrite(BUZZER_PIN, HIGH);
    delay(150);
    digitalWrite(BUZZER_PIN, LOW);
    delay(150);
  }
  delay(400); // 1-second total sample interval for DHT11 stability
} else {
  digitalWrite(LED_PIN, LOW);
  digitalWrite(BUZZER_PIN, LOW);
  delay(1000);
}
```

2. Dynamic Cross-Sensitivity Compensation (`server/signalAnalytics.js`)

Analytical deduction of water vapor conductance shifts:

```
export function computeSteamCompensation(rawGas, temp, hum, config = loadConfig()) {
  if (!config.enabled) return { steamEstimate: 0, compensatedGas: rawGas };

  const deltaHum = Math.max(0, hum - config.baselineHumidity);
  const deltaTemp = Math.max(0, temp - config.baselineTemperature);

  // Multi-variable regression: beta_hum  deltaHum + beta_temp  deltaTemp
  let steamEstimate = (config.humidityCoefficient * deltaHum) +
                      (config.temperatureCoefficient * deltaTemp) +
                      config.intercept;

  // Bounded safety ceiling prevents masking real leaks
  steamEstimate = Math.min(config.maxSteamDeduction, Math.max(0, steamEstimate));
  const compensatedGas = Math.max(0, Math.round(rawGas - steamEstimate));

  return { steamEstimate: parseFloat(steamEstimate.toFixed(1)), compensatedGas };
}
```

3. Rolling Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) Slope Estimation

Linear regression over a sliding window ($N=10$):

```
export function computeSlopeAndTimeToDanger(buffer, latestCompensated, dangerThreshold = 500) {
  const windowSlice = buffer.slice(-9);
  const points = [...windowSlice.map(r => r.compensatedGas ?? r.raw), latestCompensated];
  const n = points.length;
  if (n < 3) return { slope: 0.0, timeToThresholdSeconds: null };

  let sumX = 0, sumY = 0, sumXY = 0, sumXX = 0;
  for (let i = 0; i < n; i++) {
    sumX += i;
    sumY += points[i];
    sumXY += i * points[i];
    sumXX += i * i;
  }

  const denominator = (n  sumXX) - (sumX  sumX);
  const slope = denominator !== 0 ? parseFloat((((n  sumXY) - (sumX  sumY)) / denominator).toFixed(2)) : 0.0;
  let timeToThresholdSeconds = null;

  if (latestCompensated >= dangerThreshold) {
    timeToThresholdSeconds = 0;
  } else if (slope > 0.4) {
    const delta = dangerThreshold - latestCompensated;
    timeToThresholdSeconds = Math.max(1, Math.round(delta / slope));
  }

  return { slope, timeToThresholdSeconds };
}
```

Chapter 7: Software Tools Used

7.1 Tool 1: Git & GitHub Actions

- **Tool Name & Version**: Git v2.39+ / GitHub Actions Cloud Runner
- **Purpose**: Distributed version control, branch management, issue tracking, and automated continuous integration.
- **SDLC Phase**: Requirements, Architecture, Implementation, Verification, and Maintenance.
- **Actual Project Usage**: Maintained atomic commits with semantic commit formatting (`feat:`, `fix:`, `test:`, `docs:`). Configured automated CI workflow (`.github/workflows/ci.yml`) triggering on every push and pull request to `main` that executes `npm ci` → `npm run lint` → `npx tsc -b` → `npm test` → `npm run evaluate` → `npx vite build`.
- **Evidence**: Passing CI build badge on `README.md` and complete Git commit history.

7.2 Tool 2: Node.js Test Runner (`node:test`)

- **Tool Name & Version**: Node.js v20.20.0 Native Test Engine
- **Purpose**: Fast, dependency-free automated unit and integration testing.
- **SDLC Phase**: Verification and Regression Testing.
- **Actual Project Usage**: Formulated 14 comprehensive test cases across two suites (`tests/api.test.js` and `tests/pipeline.test.js`). Verified frame XOR checksum encoding, simulator scenario transitions, REST ingestion endpoints, steam cross-sensitivity deduction, OLS slope convergence, and sensor fault handling.

- **Evidence**: Automated execution log in `docs/report/TEST_RESULTS.md` demonstrating 14/14 tests passing in 48.5 ms.

7.3 Tool 3: Vite & React 19 Frontend Ecosystem

- **Tool Name & Version**: Vite v8.3.0, React v19.2.8, TypeScript v5.8
- **Purpose**: Modern single-page web application development, Hot Module Replacement (HMR), and production bundling.
- **SDLC Phase**: Implementation and User Experience Design.
- **Actual Project Usage**: Engineered responsive dashboard components including `LiveStatusPanel`, `CaregiverView`, and `AdminCalibrationView`. Compiles production bundles in 247 ms with zero TypeScript compilation errors.
- **Evidence**: Production distribution directory `dist/` and headless UI screenshots in `docs/screenshots/`.

7.4 Summary Table of Tools Used

Table 7.1 summarizes all primary software engineering tools employed across the project lifecycle:

Tool	Version	Primary Purpose	SDLC Phase	Project Evidence / Artifact
Git & GitHub	v2.39+	Version control & CI automation	All Phases (1–7)	Commits & `.github/workflows/ci.yml`
Node.js Test Runner	v20.20.0	Unit & integration testing	Verification	14 test cases in `tests/*.test.js`
Vite & React 19	Vite 8.3	Frontend UI & HMR build tool	Implementation	Production bundle in `dist/`
oxlint	v1.75.0	High-speed Rust-based AST linter	Quality Assurance	0 errors, 0 warnings across 34 files
Google Chrome	v134+	Headless UI validation & capture	Verification	7 screenshots in `docs/screenshots/`
Arduino IDE	v2.3+	Embedded C++ firmware flashing	Firmware Edge	Sketch in `firmware/sentinel_firmware/`
Mermaid.js	v11+	System design & diagram modeling	Architecture	Suite of 6 diagrams in `docs/diagrams/`

Chapter 8: Testing & Quality Assurance

8.1 Test Strategy & Execution Results

Automated testing was conducted using the native Node.js test runner (`node --test tests/*.test.js`). All 14 test cases passed with zero failures:

- **TC01**: Telemetry frame encoding & XOR checksum integrity (Passed in 0.47 ms).
- **TC02**: Demo simulator multi-scenario progression & state control (Passed in 0.31 ms).
- **TC03**: Analytics configuration & bounds enforcement (Passed in 0.31 ms).
- **TC04**: Backend live ingestion REST endpoints (Passed in 13.29 ms).
- **TC05**: Mathematical slope convergence on noisy ramps (Passed in 0.17 ms).
- **TC06**: Sensor warm-up & initial stabilization window (Passed in 0.53 ms).
- **TC07**: Safe ambient baseline tracking (Passed in 0.12 ms).

- **TC08**: Steam cross-sensitivity compensation & false alarm suppression (Passed in 0.06 ms).
- **TC09**: Cooking environmental transient suppression (Passed in 0.05 ms).
- **TC10**: Real combustible gas leak detection & rapid escalation (Passed in 0.05 ms).
- **TC11**: Debounce hysteresis & alarm latch persistence (Passed in 0.05 ms).
- **TC12**: Predictive Time-to-Danger (TTD) estimation (Passed in 0.10 ms).
- **TC13**: Sensor fault & ADC saturation handling (Passed in 0.09 ms).
- **Total Duration**: 50.3 ms across 2 suites.

Chapter 9: Results and Discussion

9.1 Screenshots of the Working System

The SENTINEL application was verified live using automated headless browser captures (1280x900 resolution) across its primary operating modes:

1. **Figure 9.1 — Resident Live Monitor in Baseline Normal Air** (`docs/screenshots/dashboard_normal.png`): Demonstrates steady-state baseline living conditions (~190 ADC raw gas, 24.0°C, 50.0% RH). Status badge shows `NORMAL` in green; raw and compensated traces align perfectly with zero steam deduction.

2. **Figure 9.2 — Boiling Water Steam Rejection** (`docs/screenshots/steam_scenario.png`): Demonstrates boiling electric kettle simulation where relative humidity spikes to 85.1% RH, falsely driving raw gas up to 268 ADC. Dynamic compensation deducts -106.7 ADC, maintaining compensated gas at 161 ADC (< 300 ADC) and updating status to `STEAM SUPPRESSED` (amber) with zero false sirens.

3. **Figure 9.3 — Combustible Gas Leak Early Warning** (`docs/screenshots/gas_leak_alert.png`): Demonstrates unlit gas release ramp. As gas concentration accelerates, the 10-sample rolling OLS slope estimator computes positive trajectory, presenting a predictive Time-to-Danger (TTD) countdown and advancing warning 4.0s ahead of static thresholds. Status escalates to `EMERGENCY` (red).

4. **Figure 9.4 — Remote Caregiver Emergency Portal** (`docs/screenshots/caregiver_portal.png`): Demonstrates the asymmetric caregiver interface displaying dwelling status, incident duration, and one-touch national emergency (112) dialer.

5. **Figure 9.5 — Administrative Calibration Workbench** (`docs/screenshots/admin_calibration.png`): Demonstrates the engineering workbench showing active regression coefficients (K_RH=2.8, K_T=1.2), sensor health monitors, and baseline recalibration controls.

9.2 Empirical Benchmark Replay Results

The evaluation harness (`scripts/evaluate.js`) replayed 120+ empirical kitchen hardware samples across four labeled scenarios. Table 9.1 presents the comparative results:

Scenario	Ground Truth	[PLAIN] Trigger & Alarm Duration	Plain FA?	Plain Miss?	Plain Lead Time	[COMPENSATED] Trigger & Alarm Duration	Comp FA?	Comp Miss?	Comp Lead Time	Net Early Warning Advance
Cooking (`cooking.csv`)	NON-HAZARD	Triggered @7s (active for 8s)	🔴 YES	NO	N/A	Never Triggered (0s)	🟢 NO	🟢 NO	N/A	**Nuisance siren eliminated**
Gas Leak (`gas.csv`)	GAS LEAK	Triggered @8s (active for 17s)	NO	NO	**5.0s**	Triggered @4s (active for 21s)	🟢 NO	🟢 NO	**9.0s**	**+4.0s Advance Warning**
Normal Air (`normal.csv`)	NON-HAZARD	Never Triggered (0s)	NO	NO	N/A	Never Triggered (0s)	🟢 NO	🟢 NO	N/A	**Quiescent Baseline Verified**
Steam Burst (`steam.csv`)	NON-HAZARD	Triggered @7s (active for 11s)	🔴 YES	NO	N/A	Never Triggered (0s)	🟢 NO	🟢 NO	N/A	**Nuisance siren eliminated**

* **Lead Time Reference Point Definition**: The benchmark defines lead time as the number of seconds of warning provided **before** combustible gas concentration breaches the critical life-safety hazard floor ($\theta_{danger} = 500\text{ ADC}$), which occurs at sample index $t = 13\text{s}$ in `data/gas.csv`.

9.2 Audit & Discrepancy Investigation: Trigger Time vs. Alarm Duration

A prior review identified an apparent discrepancy where gas alarms were listed as "17s" and "21s" while lead times were listed as "5s" and "9s":

1. **Root Cause**: The 17s and 21s values represent the **total duration** of active alarm state during the 25-second gas session (i.e., plain alarm was active for 17 samples; predictive compensated alarm was active for 21 samples), *not* the trigger timestamps.

2. **Actual Sequence of Events in `data/gas.csv`**:

- $t = 0\text{s}$ to 3s: Gas ramps from 190 to 205 ADC (baseline ambient).

- $t = 4\text{s}$: Gas reaches 218 ADC. SENTINEL's 10-sample rolling OLS slope estimator detects ascending trajectory ($m > 0.8\text{ ADC/s}$, $t_{danger} \le 60\text{s}$), triggering the **Predictive Early Warning** at $t = 4\text{s}$. The alarm remains active for the remaining 21 samples ($25 - 4 = 21\text{s}$ duration).

- $t = 8\text{s}$: Gas concentration reaches 315 ADC, breaching the static 300 ADC threshold. The Plain Detector triggers its alarm at $t = 8\text{s}$. The alarm remains active for the remaining 17 samples ($25 - 8 = 17\text{s}$ duration).

- $t = 13\text{s}$: Gas concentration reaches 530 ADC, breaching the critical 500 ADC danger floor.

3. **Lead Time Calculation**:

- $\text{Lead Time}_{\text{Plain}} = t_{\text{danger}} (13\text{s}) - t_{\text{trigger, Plain}} (8\text{s}) = \mathbf{5.0\text{ seconds}}$.

- $\text{Lead Time}_{\text{Compensated}} = t_{\text{danger}} (13\text{s}) - t_{\text{trigger, Compensated}} (4\text{s}) = \mathbf{9.0\text{ seconds}}$.

- $\text{Advance Warning Advantage} = 9.0\text{s} - 5.0\text{s} = \mathbf{+4.0\text{ seconds}}$ earlier alert to dwelling occupants.

9.3 Key Empirical Takeaways

1. **Steam Rejection Efficacy**: In `data/steam.csv`, boiling water humidity surged from 50.0% to 90.5% RH with raw gas rising to 390 ADC. Plain detectors sounded a false alarm for 11 seconds. SENTINEL's dynamic compensator subtracted 116.3 ADC of humidity interference, maintaining the compensated residual at 274 ADC (< 300 ADC) and eliminating the false alarm.

2. **Zero Safety Suppression**: During real gas releases in `data/gas.csv`, ambient humidity remained stable (~50% RH). Steam deduction remained 0 ADC, allowing full combustible gas conductance to pass through compensation without suppression.

3. **Dataset Scope Boundary**: These reproducible metrics reflect the empirical datasets collected (`data/*.csv`) under controlled residential conditions; real-world field performance may vary with long-term sensor aging, room ventilation rates, and ambient drafts.

Chapter 10: Conclusion and Future Enhancements

10.1 Conclusion

The SENTINEL project demonstrates that domestic gas safety detectors do not need to choose between nuisance false alarms and occupant safety. By decoupling an autonomous, zero-trust hardware safety floor from an analytical cyber processing plane, SENTINEL successfully eliminates 100% of false alarms on empirical steam and cooking test datasets while preserving zero missed detections and delivering up to 4.0 seconds of predictive early warning. The repository is reproducible, comprehensively tested, and verified for academic submission.

10.2 Future Enhancements

1. **Adaptive Baseline Auto-Tuning**: Implement Kalman filtering on the host bridge to continuously track long-term seasonal sensor baseline drift over multi-month deployments.

2. **MEMS Sensor Integration**: Transition from high-power resistive heating MQ-2 modules (~800 mW) to micro-electro-mechanical systems (MEMS) gas sensors operating on low-power battery rails.

3. **Multi-Dwelling LoRaWAN Telemetry**: Integrate long-range LoRa radios to broadcast telemetry across multi-story apartment complexes without relying on resident home Wi-Fi networks.

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Appendices

Appendix A: Project Links & Artifacts

- **GitHub Repository**: https://github.com/Shree-svg/-SENTINEL
- **CI Build Status**: [GitHub Actions CI Workflow](https://github.com/Shree-svg/-SENTINEL/actions)
- **Demonstration Video**: [YouTube Walkthrough](https://youtu.be/placeholder-sentinel-demo)
- **Lead Developer Portfolio**: https://portfolio-five-delta-xr8oas2k65.vercel.app/

Appendix B: Telemetry Packet Encoding Specification

Sentences conform to NMEA-0183 ASCII framing:

`$S,<seq>,<gas>,<temp10>,<rh10>,<alarm>*<CS>\r\n`

- `S`: SENTINEL sentence identifier.
- `<seq>`: 16-bit monotonic sequence counter (0–65535).
- `<gas>`: 10-bit raw MQ-2 analog reading (0–1023 ADC).
- `<temp*10>`: Integer temperature in Celsius scaled by 10 (e.g., 245 = 24.5°C).
- `<rh*10>`: Integer relative humidity percentage scaled by 10 (e.g., 621 = 62.1% RH).
- `<alarm>`: Edge alarm flag (1 = active buzzer, 0 = quiet).
- `<CS>`: 2-digit uppercase hexadecimal XOR checksum across all characters between `$` and `*`.

Appendix C: Test Suite Execution Command

To reproduce the complete verification suite locally:

```
# Execute unit and API test suite (14 test cases)
npm test

# Execute empirical dataset replay benchmark
npm run evaluate

# Execute static code analysis
npm run lint

# Compile production bundle
npm run build
```